



PARISHRAM 2027

Lost Spring II -
I Want To Drive A Car

LECTURE : 05

English Class 12

By Anurag Tyagi Sir



Topics to be Covered

1 Warm-up Game

2 Lost Spring II : I Want to Drive a Car

3 Exercise and Quiz



Game time

WHICH SENTENCE IS GRAMMATICALLY CORRECT?

01



A She don't like pizza. ✗

☒ B She doesn't like pizza. ✓

C She doesn't likes pizza. ✗

02



A They was playing cricket. ✗

☒ B They were playing cricket. ✓

C They were plays cricket.

03



A I has a new watch.

☒ B I have a new watch. ✓

C I have a new watches. ✗



WHICH SENTENCE IS GRAMMATICALLY CORRECT?



ANSWERS

01



A She doesn't like pizza.



B She don't like pizza.

C She no like pizza.

02



A They was playing cricket.

B They playing cricket.

C They were playing cricket.



03



A I has a new watch.

B I have a new watches.

C I have a new watch.



The cricket team gave their best and won fair and square.

A) By cheating

B) Without practice

C) By luck only

✓ D) Clearly and honestly

The old bridge looked fragile, so the hikers crossed it carefully.

- A) Strong and heavy
- B) Bright and colourful
-  C) Easy to break
- D) Very expensive

The background of the image is a detailed illustration. On the left, a boy is working in a workshop, pouring molten metal from a ladle into a mold. In the foreground, there are several colorful, beaded necklaces. On the right, a boy stands in a dusty, impoverished street, looking up with a hopeful expression. In the background, other children are visible, and a mosque with a dome and minaret is seen in the distance under a clear sky.

I WANT TO DRIVE A CAR

By
Anees Jung

Say firmly

Mukesh insists on being his own master. "I will be a motor mechanic," he announces.

"Do you know anything about cars?" I ask.

"I will learn to drive a car," he answers,

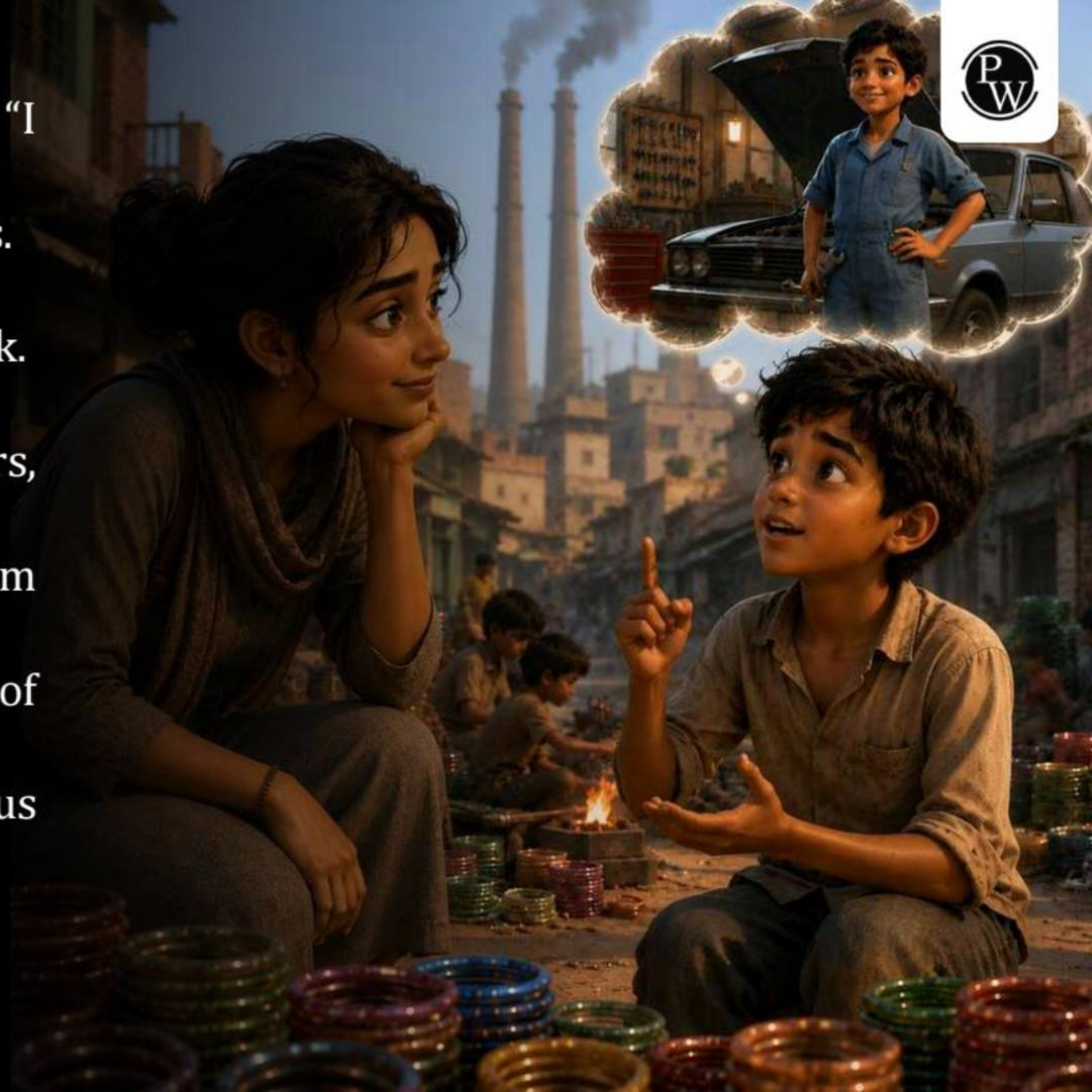
Confidence

looking straight into my eyes. His dream

looks bigger
looks like a *illusion* among mirage amidst the dust of

streets that fill his town Firozabad famous

for its bangles.



Many
Every other family in Firozabad is
engaged in making bangles. It is the
melting glass & making bangles
centre of India's glass-blowing
industry where families have spent
ਜਿਹੜੀ ; hot oven
generations working around furnaces,
joining together
welding glass, making bangles for all
Country
the women in the land it seems.



Mukesh's family is among them. None of them know that it is illegal for children like him to work in the glass furnaces with high *dark, dirty, & small spaces* temperatures, in dingy cells without air and light; that the law, if *ਮਾਮੂਲਾ ਕਰਾਹੀ; excited* enforced, could get him and all those 20,000 children out of the hot *work hard* furnaces where they slog their daylight hours, *ਝੋਲਾਝੋਲਾ* often losing the brightness of their eyes.



Shine with Happiness

Mukesh's eyes beam as he volunteers to

offer willingly

take me home, which he proudly says is

repaired; remade

bad smelling

being rebuilt. We walk down stinking

path

lanes choked with garbage, past homes

blocked; covered

breaking

that remain hovels with crumbling

poorly built but

walls, wobbly doors, no windows,

shaky

As crowded with families of humans and

living together

animals coexisting in a primeval state.

primitive



He stops at the door of one such
house, hits open a wobbly iron door with
his foot, and pushes it open. We enter
a half-built hut shack.
poorly constructed



covered with; roof of

In one part of it, thatched with dead grass, is a

ਫਾਇਰ

firewood stove over which sits a large vessel

ਪਲਾਟ

of sizzling spinach leaves. On the ground, in

cut

large aluminium platters, are more chopped

weak

vegetables. A frail young woman is cooking

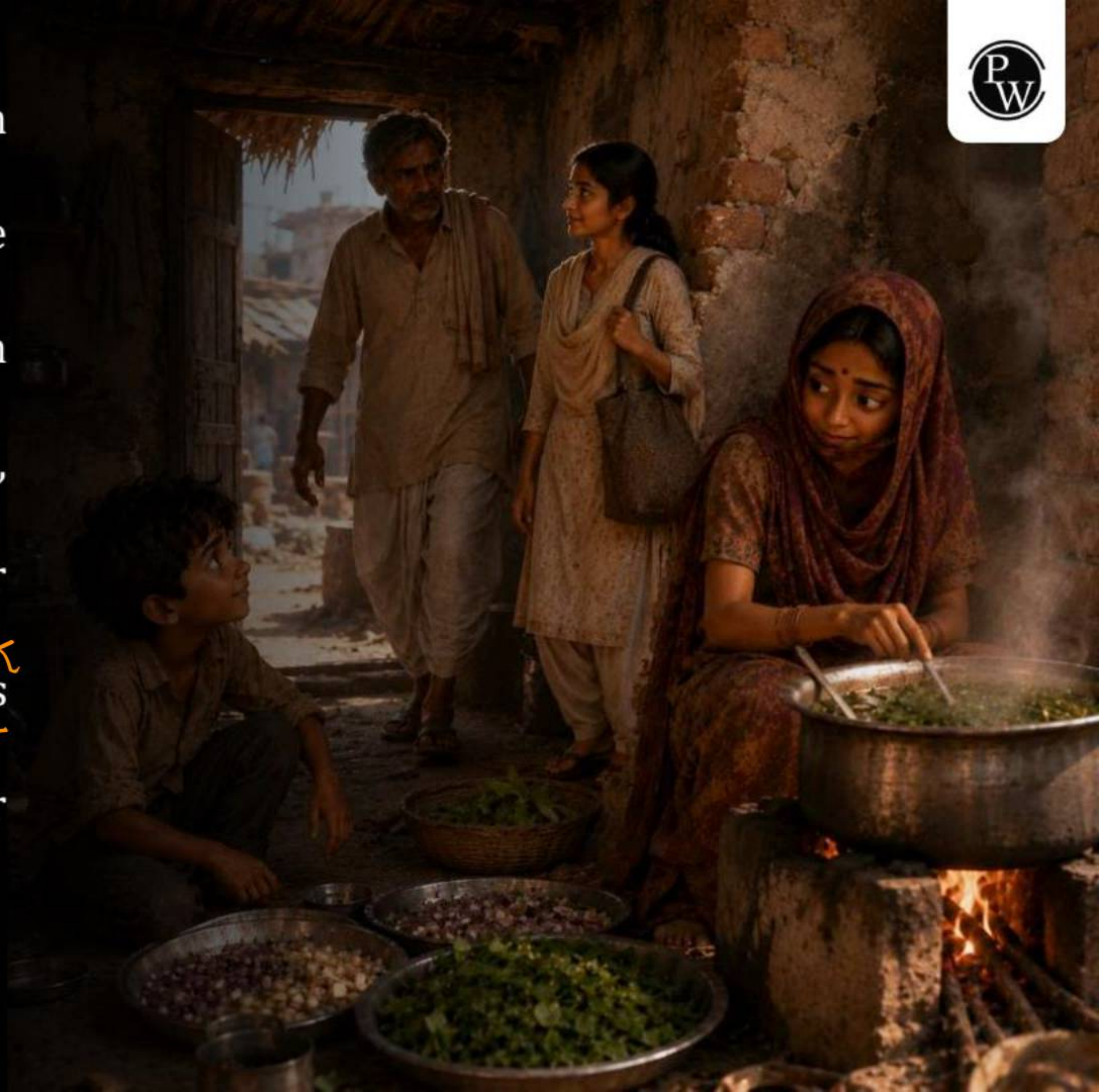
the evening meal for the whole family.

Through eyes filled with smoke she smiles.

She is the wife of Mukesh's elder brother.



Not much older in years, she has begun *get* to command respect as the bahu, the daughter-in-law of the house, already in *responsible* charge of three men—her husband, Mukesh and their father. When the older man enters, she *softly* gently *moves back* withdraws behind the broken wall and brings her *face* veil closer to her face.



रिवाज asks for

As custom demands, daughters-in-law must

cover

veil their faces before male elders. In this case

very poor

the elder is an impoverished bangle maker.

Despite long years of hard labour, first as a

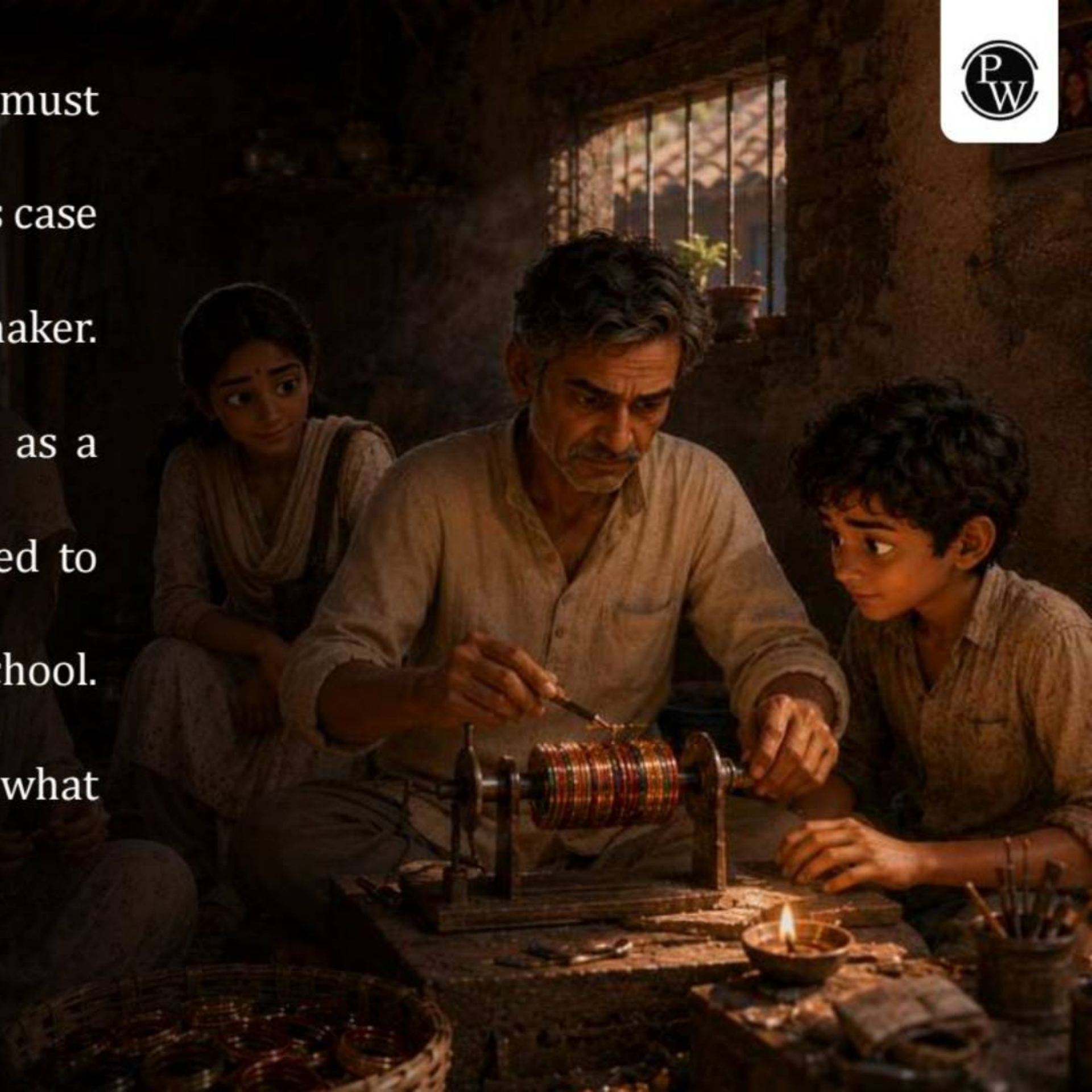
tailor, then a bangle maker, he has failed to

repair

renovate a house, send his two sons to school.

All he has managed to do is teach them what

he knows—the art of making bangles.



नियति

"It is his karam, his destiny," says Mukesh's grandmother, who has watched her own husband go blind with the dust from polishing the glass of bangles.

anxiety; Mutation

"Can a god-given lineage ever be broken?" she implies. *Suggest*



Born in the caste of bangle makers,
they have seen nothing but bangles
—in the house, in the ^{open area} yard, in every
other house, every other yard, every
street in Firozabad.



What illegal practice is highlighted in the extract regarding children?

- A) Selling goods in the market
- ☒ B) Working in glass furnaces
- C) Driving cars
- D) Attending school without permission

What profession does Mukesh aspire to pursue?

- A) Bangle maker
- ✓ B) Motor Mechanic
- C) Tailor
- D) Glass blower

Mukesh's grandmother believes that

- ☒ **A)** It is their karma to be working in bangle factories.
- B)** The government will give them jobs.
- C)** Mukesh will one day go to school.
- D)** They are fortunate people to be working in a bangle factory.

Spirals of bangles — sunny gold, paddy green, royal blue, pink, purple, every colour born out of the seven colours of the rainbow — lie in heaps in untidy unkempt yards, are piled on four-wheeled handcarts, pushed by young men along the narrow lanes of the shanty town.



Spiral ↗

And in dark hutments, next to lines of
लोह फिमरिमना
flames of flickering oil lamps, sit boys and
girls with their fathers and mothers,
joining together
welding pieces of coloured glass into circles
of bangles. Their eyes are more adjusted to
the dark than to the light outside. That is
why they often end up losing their eyesight
before they become adults.



Savita, a young girl in a drab pink dress, sits next to alongside an elderly woman, soldering pieces of glass. As her hands move mechanically like the hands of a machine, I wonder if she knows the sanctity of the bangles she helps make.



It symbolises an Indian woman's
suhaag, good luck auspiciousness in marriage.

It will suddenly realise dawn on her suddenly one day
when her head is covered draped with a red
veil, her hands dyed red with henna,
and red bangles rolled onto her
wrists.



She will then become a bride. Like the old woman beside her who became one many years ago. She still has bangles on her wrist, but no light in her eyes. “Ek waqt ser bhar khana bhi nahin khaya,” she says, in a voice devoid; without joy drained of joy.



She has not enjoyed even one full meal in her entire lifetime — that's what she has reaped! Her husband, an old man with a big beard flowing beard, says, "I know nothing except bangles. All I have done is make a house for the family to live in."



ईरत

Hearing him, one wonders if he has achieved what many have failed in their lifetime. He has a roof over his head!



The problem cry of not having money to do anything except continue carry on the business of making bangles, not even enough to eat, echoes in every home. The young men repeat echo the sadness lament of their elders. Little has changed moved with time, it seems, in Firozabad. Years of exhausting hard labour mind-numbing toil have killed all ability to start something new initiative and the ability to dream.



“Why not organise yourselves into a
ਸੰਘਗਿਤ
cooperative?” I ask a group of young men

who have fallen into the *dangerous loop*
vicious circle of

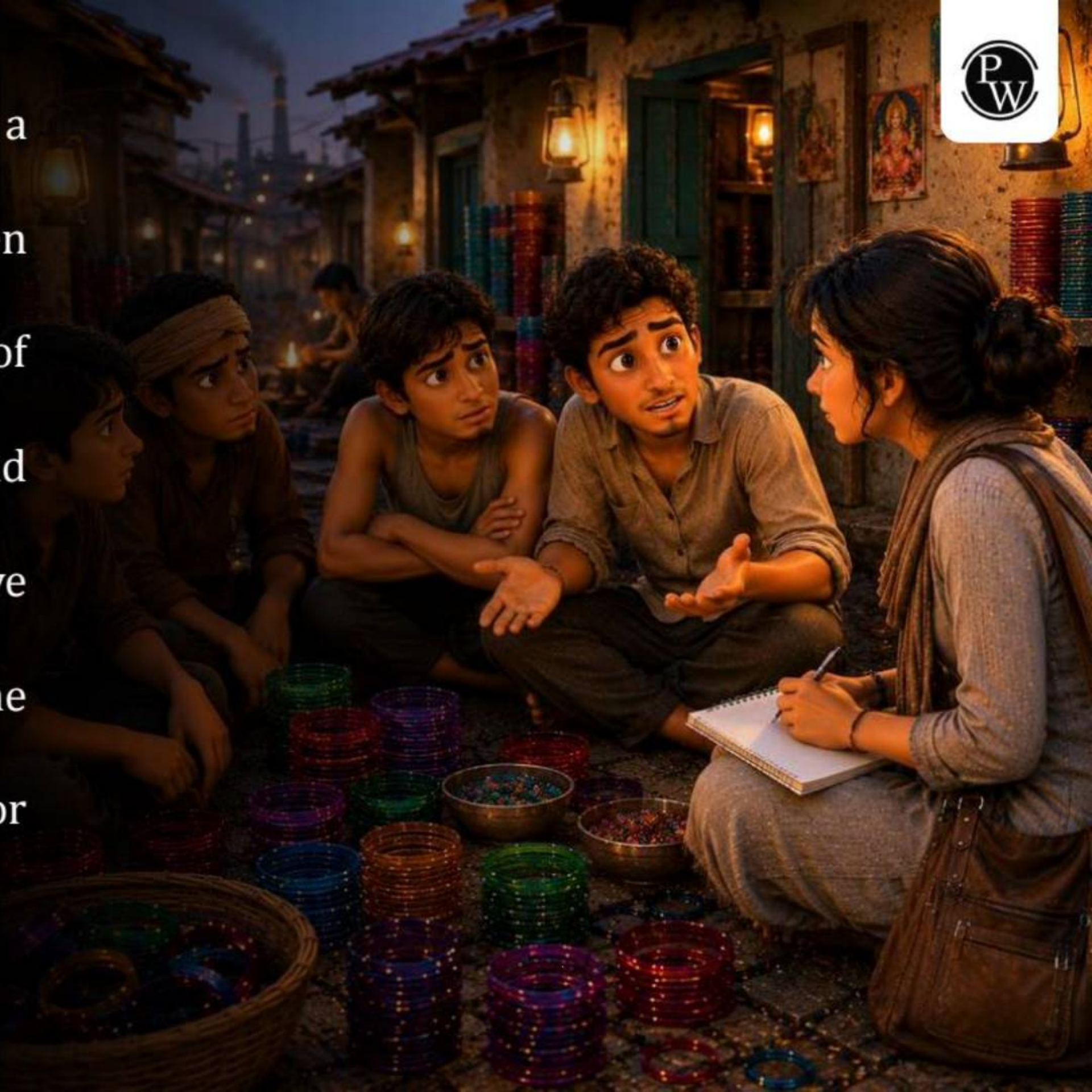
middlemen who trapped their fathers and

forefathers. “Even if we get organised, we

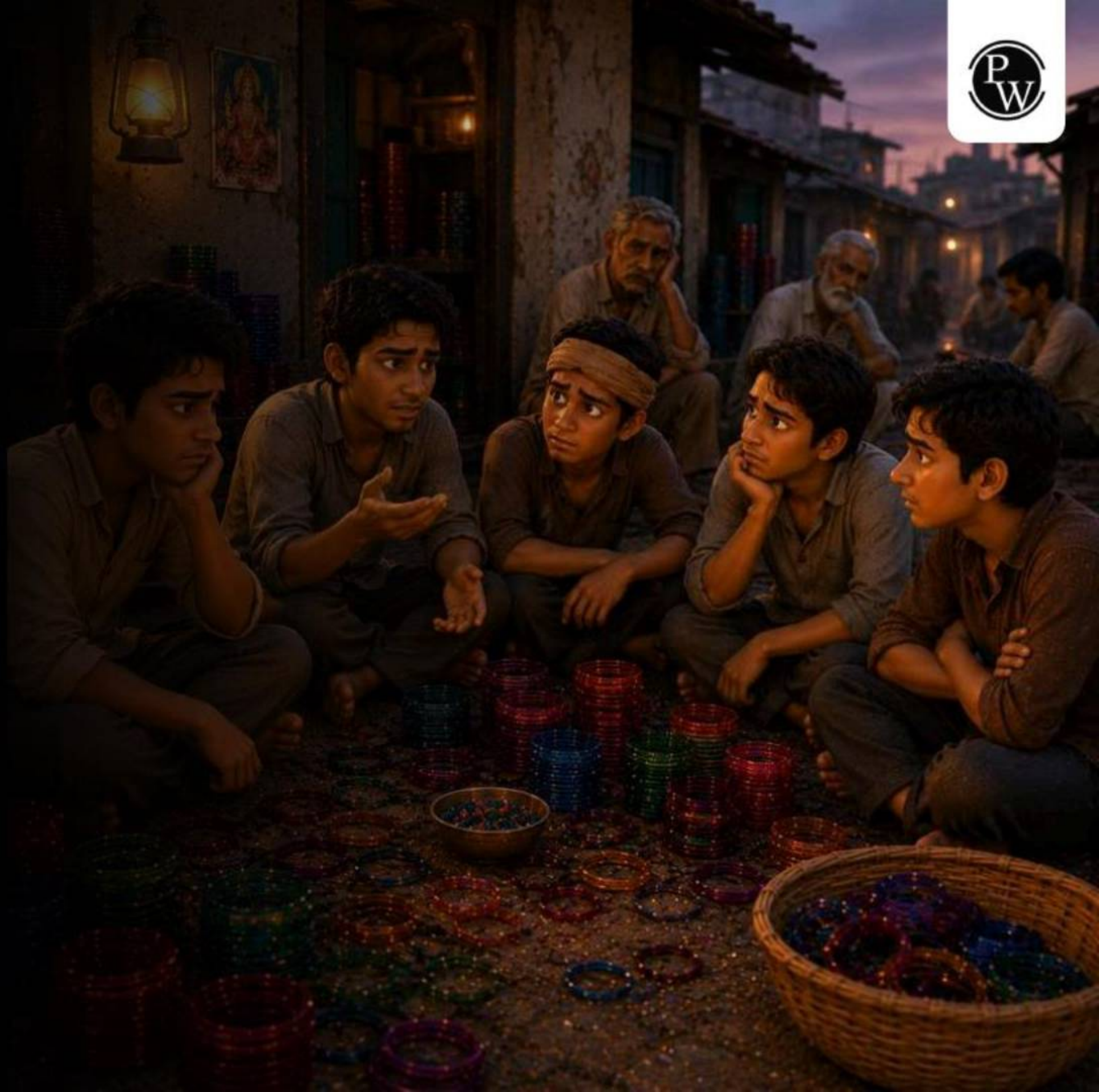
are the ones who will be *forcibly jailed*
hailed up by the

police, beaten and dragged to jail for

doing something illegal,” they say.



There is no leader among them, no one who could help them see things differently. Their fathers are as tired as they are. They talk endlessly in a spiral that moves from poverty to *hopelessness* *નિરાશ* *ઝિંદગી* apathy to greed and to injustice.



Listening to them, I see two ^{different} distinct

worlds — one of the family, caught in

^{जाला; trap} a web of poverty, ^{बोझ} burdened by the

^{कलंक} stigma of caste in which they are born;

the other a vicious circle of the

sahukars, the middlemen, the

policemen, the keepers of law, the

bureaucrats and the politicians.



Together they have *put forcibly* imposed the baggage on the child that he cannot put down. Before he is aware, he accepts it as naturally as his father. To *हिम्मत करना* do anything else would mean to dare. And daring is not part of his growing up.



light

When I sense a flash of it in Mukesh I am cheered. "I want to be a motor mechanic," he repeats. He will go to a garage and learn. But the garage is a long way from his home. "I will walk," he insists. "Do you also dream of flying a plane?" He is suddenly silent. "No," he says, staring at the ground.



to speak slowly

In his small murmur there is an

embarrassment that has not yet

turned into regret. He is satisfied to

dream of cars that he sees hurtling

moving quickly
down the streets of his town. Few

airplanes fly over Firozabad. //



Key Notes

Mukesh: a child labourer in a glass factory in Firozabad

- wishes to be a motor mechanic
- wants to learn to drive a car
- his family unaware that child labour is illegal and banned by law



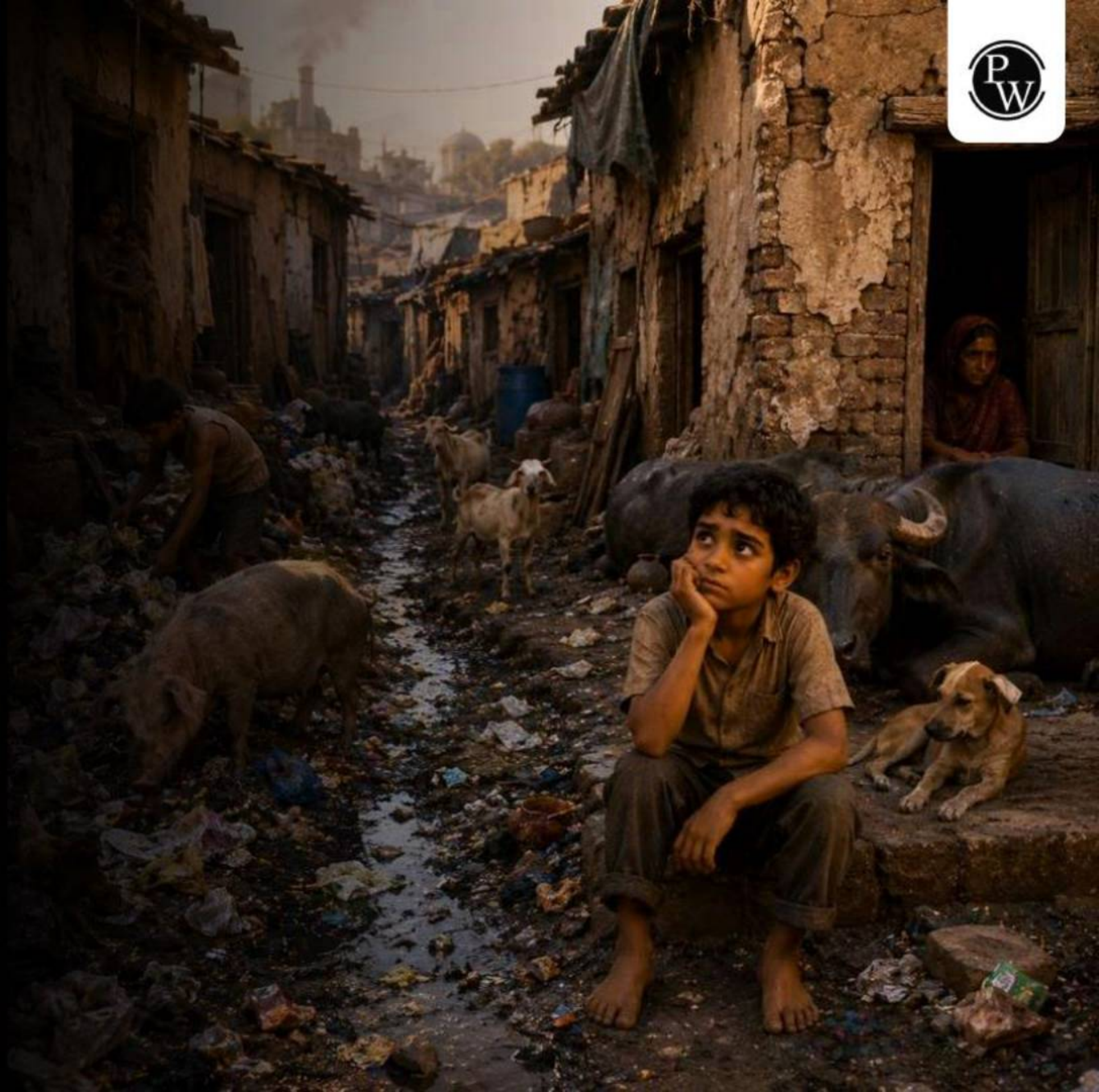
Working conditions in glass furnaces

- high temperatures
- dingy ill-lit cells
- Poorly ventilated.
- children lose eyesight at an early age.



Living conditions in Firozabad

- stinking lanes choked with garbage
- houses with crumbling walls, wobbly doors and no windows
- humans and animals both live together in these hovels



Author visits Mukesh's house

- Mukesh's house, a half-built shack with thatched dead grass roof and a wobbly iron door
- firewood stove, aluminium utensils
- houses three generations: grandmother, father, elder brother and his wife
- elder brother's wife:
 - 1.responsible for family members' welfare and cooking
 - 2.obeys custom of covering face with veil in front of male elders



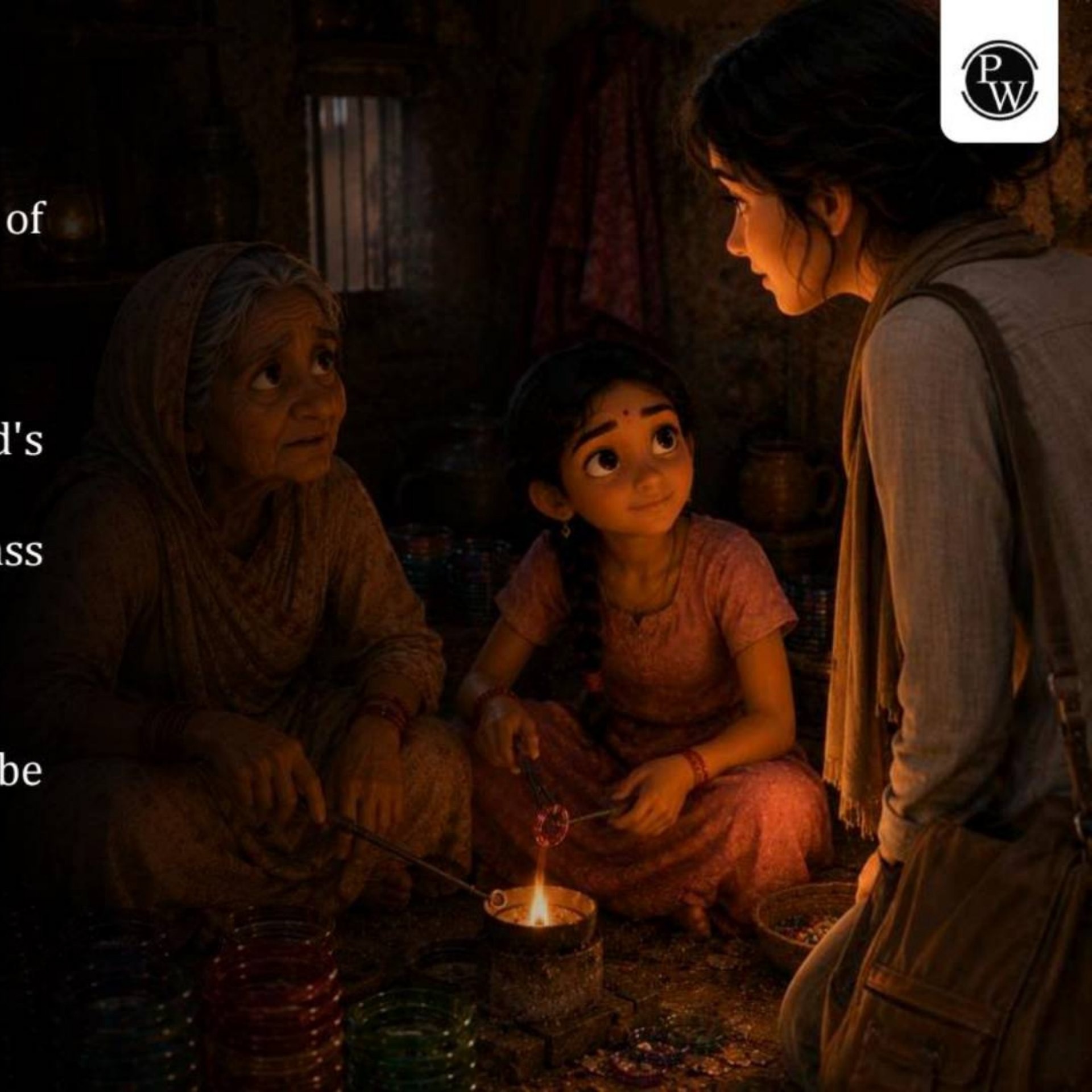
Author visits Mukesh's house

- Mukesh's father:
 1. head of the family
 2. poverty-stricken
 3. unable to renovate house or provide education to two sons
- only legacy he can hand over is the art of bangle making



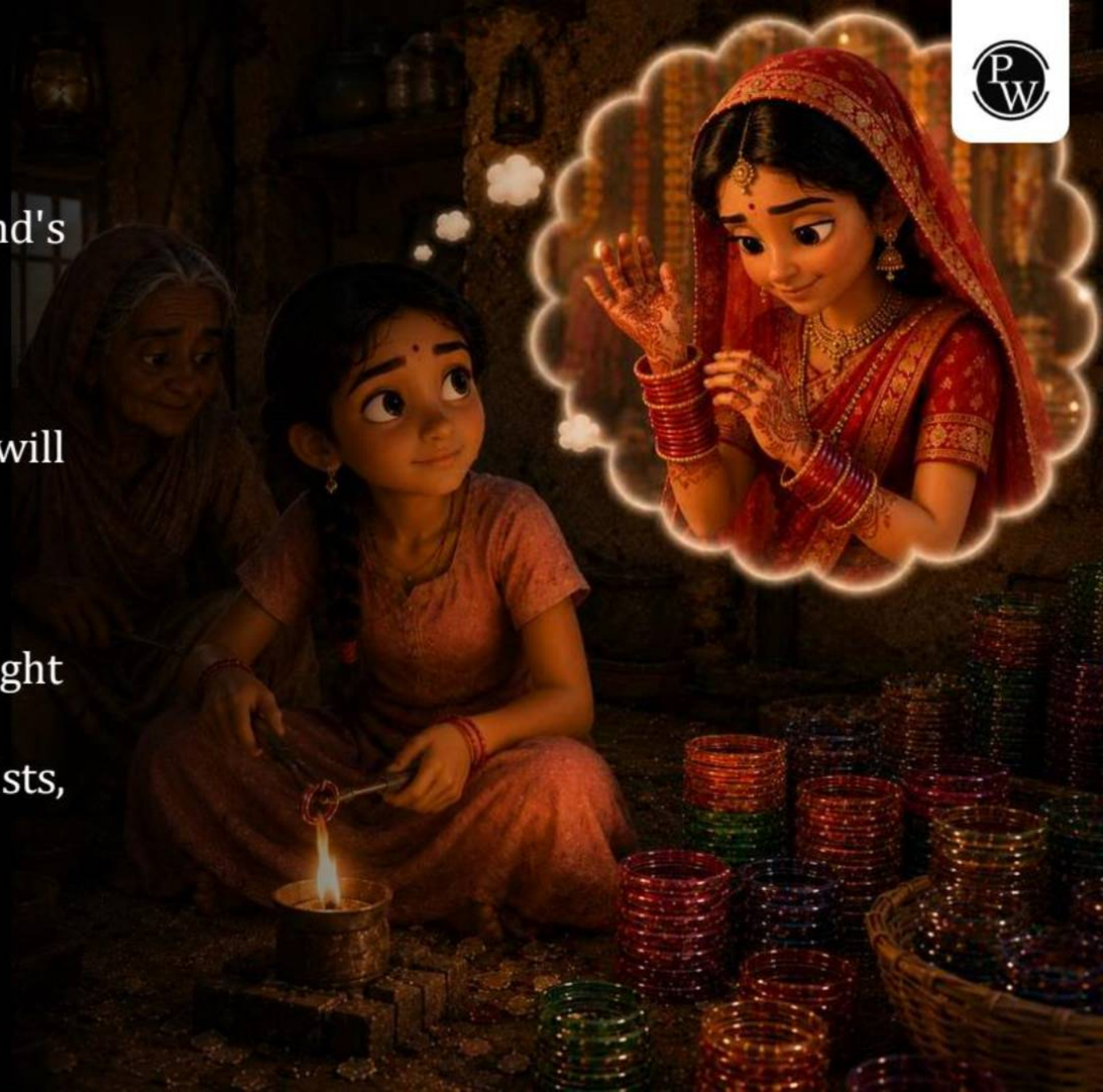
Mukesh's Grandmother's view of life

- present state of affairs is a result of 'karma' or 'destiny'
- has quietly accepted her husband's blindness caused by dust of glass bangles
- believes in 'art of bangle making' to be God-given lineage



Irony in perception

- bangles: a symbol of 'suhaag' (husband's long life)
- eventually all girl-child labourers will become brides
- will wear same bangles but lose eyesight
- become old with bangles on wrists, sightless eyes and empty stomachs



Time stands still in Firozabad

- no progress, no development despite years of mindnumbing toil
- poverty, illiteracy, dissatisfaction prevails
- all labourers victims of exploitation at the hands of middlemen and touts



Getting organised into a cooperative society – a way out

- fear of police, lack of leadership, trap of middlemen: obstacles in the way of running cooperative society
- caught in a vicious circle of poverty: indifference, greed, injustice meted out to them



Children: victim of two worlds

- First: born in poverty ridden family, with the stigma of caste
- Second: suppressed by sahukaars, middlemen, policemen, bureaucrats & politicians

Courage dissolved backbone broken

- desire to dream and dare snubbed in childhood



Mukesh: an exception

- aspires to be a motor mechanic
- also realizes that dreaming of airplanes would be over-reaching himself
- ironically few planes fly over Firozabad



Topic: Glossary



- **Mirage** – illusion
- **Furnace** – an enclosed structure in which heat is produced for reducing ores
- **Dingy** – dark and dirty
- **Slog** – work hard
- **Beam** – sparkle; glow
- **Volunteers** – (here) offers himself (for some service or understanding)
- **Stinking** – having a very strong unpleasant smell

- **Choked** – blocked
- **Hovels** – dirty houses that are unfit to live in
- **Wobbly** – shaky
- **Shack** – a small building, usually made of wood or steel
- **Platters** – large plates used for serving food
- **Chopped** – cut into fine pieces
- **Frail** – physically weak and thin
- **Veil** – a covering worn especially by women to protect or hide the face

- **Impoverished** – very poor; without money
- **Renovate** – repair and make changes
- **Lineage** – ancestry
- **Implies** – suggests
- **Mounds** – heaps
- **Unkempt** – not neat; untidy
- **Shanty** – a small crudely built shelter
- **Hutments** – a collection of huts

- **Flickering** – (of a light or flame) going on and off as it shines or burns
- **Drab** – dull
- **Soldering** – joining together
- **Sanctity** – the state of being very important and worth protecting
- **Auspiciousness** – good fortune
- **Dawn on her** – she will begin to realize
- **Draped** – covered
- **Drained** – very tired and without energy

- **Reaped** – obtained after working hard
- **Lament** – express great sadness or disappointment
- **Mind-numbing** – very boring
- **Toil** – hard work
- **Vicious circle** – a situation in which one problem causes another problem which then makes the first problem worse
- **Hauled up** – made to appear in court or before an authority for judgment
- **Dragged** – pulled along with effort and difficulty

- **Apathy** – indifference
- **Distinct** – clearly seen, heard, or felt
- **Stigma** – mark of disgrace
- **Imposed** – to establish (something) by force
- **Content** – satisfied
- **Hurling** – moving very fast

Summary



Mukesh is another young boy whom the author meets. This boy belongs to a family of bangle makers in Firozabad. He wishes to be a motor mechanic and is willing to walk miles for training. However, a peep into the lives of his family members and other bangle makers like them reveals yet another squalor filled existence which is without hope or dignity. The writer is moved by the deplorable working conditions in the glass furnaces. Poor ventilation, high temperatures, and dim lights cause loss of eyesight at an early age in the workers here.

The writer is equally disturbed to see the living areas of these workers. Their houses do not have windows, doors are wobbly, and walls may crumble any time. Their lanes stink with choked garbage.

During the visit to the houses of bangle workers, Anees also gets a chance to sneak into the lives of Savita, a young girl in the bangle making industry, Mukesh's sister-in-law and his grandmother. A discussion with them makes it clear that these people have given up efforts to improve their lot. They have accepted their victimisation as their destiny.

Poverty and lack of education has trapped these people in a vicious circle that seems impossible to escape from. Even the menfolk do not wish to organize cooperatives or make any other effort that could give them a better life. The children born in these families particularly face dual victimisation. First, due to poverty and second, due to suppression at the hands of middlemen, police, politicians, and bureaucrats. However, Mukesh is an exception and his determination to become a motor mechanic shall perhaps be the first ray of hope for all.

A look into the lives of depravity led by the slum children is an attempt by the writer to evoke a sense of responsibility in each one of us to work collectively towards their upliftment.

A scene from a movie showing a young boy with curly hair looking out over a city at sunset. In the background, there are industrial buildings with smokestacks on the left and modern skyscrapers on the right. Three men are visible in the distance on the right.

NCERT



Questions



Q1. What makes the city of Firozabad famous?

Q2. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry.

Q3. How is Mukesh's attitude to his situation different from that of his family?

Q4. What could be some of the reasons for the migration of people from villages to cities?

Q5. Would you agree that promises made to poor children are rarely kept? Why do you think this happens in the incidents narrated in the text?

Q6. What forces conspire to keep the workers in the bangle industry of Firozabad in poverty?

Q7. How, in your opinion, can Mukesh realise his dream?

Q8. Why should child labour be eliminated and how?

Q9. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry.

Q10. Lost Spring and Indigo bring out how the common man is a victim of exploitation.

Explain.

Q1. What makes the city of Firozabad famous?

Answer

Firozabad is famous for its glass bangle industry. Almost every other family in the city is engaged in making bangles. Families have worked for generations around furnaces, welding glass and shaping colourful bangles that are worn by women across India.

Q2. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry

Answer

Working in the glass bangles industry is extremely dangerous. Children work near hot furnaces in dark, poorly ventilated rooms. They are exposed to high temperatures, smoke, dust and glass particles. Because their eyes remain adjusted to darkness for long hours, many workers lose their eyesight before adulthood.

Q3. How is Mukesh's attitude to his situation different from that of his family?

Answer

Mukesh's family accepts bangle-making as their destiny because of poverty and caste tradition. However, Mukesh is different because he dares to dream. He wants to become a motor mechanic and learn to drive a car. His dream shows courage, hope and a desire to break free from the cycle.

Q4. What could be some of the reasons for the migration of people from villages to cities?

Answer

People migrate from villages to cities because of poverty, lack of jobs, natural disasters, crop failure, floods, droughts and lack of basic facilities. In the chapter, Saheb's family leaves Dhaka because storms destroy their fields and homes. They come to the city in search of food, work and survival.

Q5. Would you agree that promises made to poor children are rarely kept? Why do you think this happens in the incidents narrated in the text?

Answer

Yes, promises made to poor children are often not kept. The narrator casually promises Saheb a school but later feels embarrassed because it was not serious. This shows how society gives hope to poor children without taking real action. Their poverty makes them dependent on promises that rarely turn into reality.

Q6. What forces conspire to keep the workers in the bangle industry of Firozabad in poverty?

Answer

The workers are trapped by many forces: poverty, caste tradition, lack of education, middlemen, sahkars, police, bureaucrats and politicians. These forces exploit them and prevent them from organising themselves. Fear, helplessness and lack of leadership keep them stuck in the same cycle of labour and poverty.

Q7. How, in your opinion, can Mukesh realise his dream?

Answer

Mukesh can realise his dream if he gets education, training and support. He needs to join a garage as an apprentice and learn motor mechanics. Government schemes, NGOs or social workers can help him with vocational training. Most importantly, he needs courage and opportunity to move beyond his family's traditional occupation.

Q8. Why should child labour be eliminated and how?

Answer

Child labour should be eliminated because it steals childhood, education, health and freedom from children. It forces them into unsafe work at a young age. It can be removed through strict enforcement of laws, free education, financial support to poor families, awareness campaigns and rehabilitation programmes for working children.

Q9. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry.

Answer

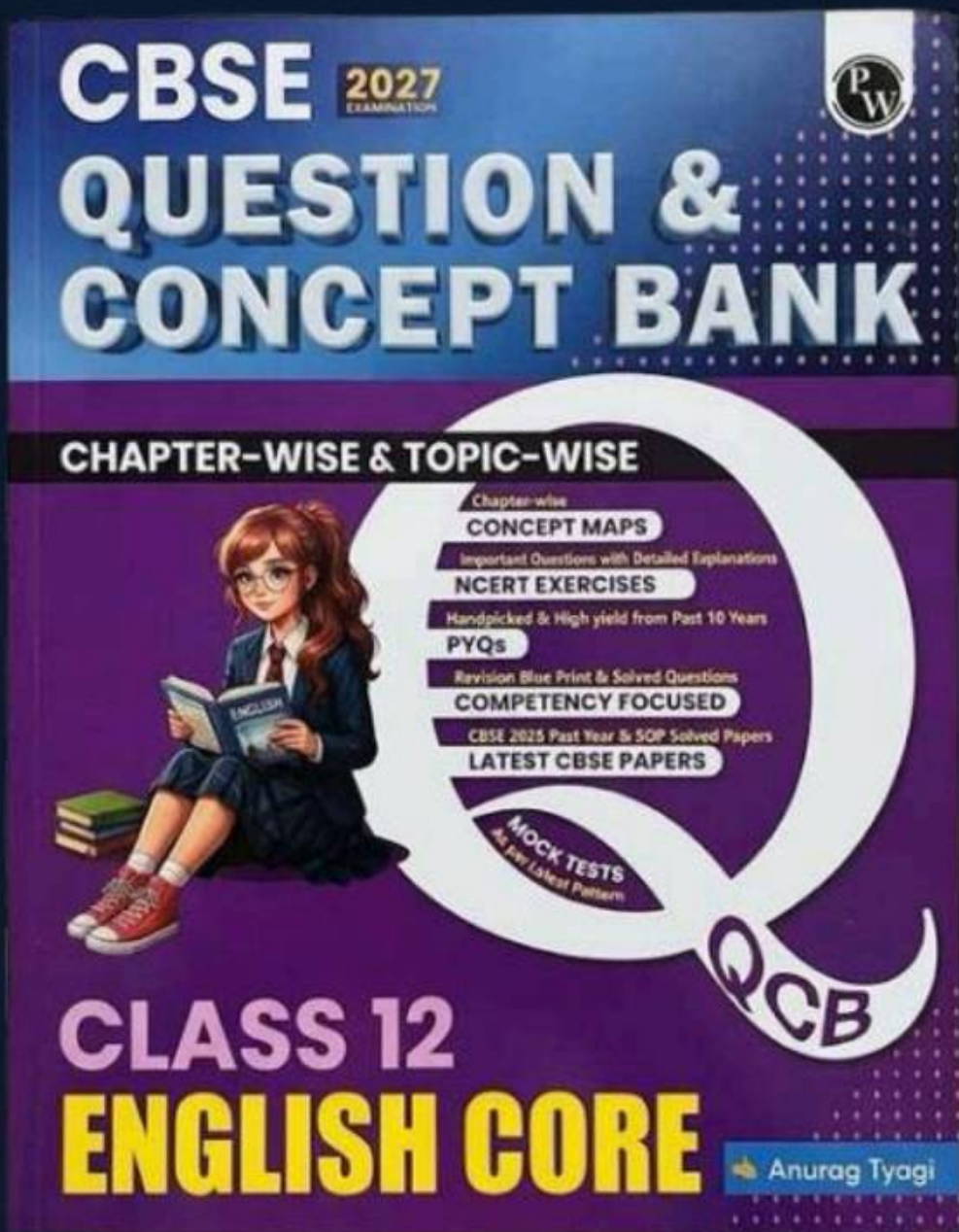
The glass bangles industry exposes workers to serious health risks. They work in dingy rooms without proper air and light. The heat of furnaces, glass dust and continuous strain damage their eyes. Many children lose their eyesight early. Long working hours also harm their physical and mental development.

Q10. Lost Spring and Indigo bring out how the common man is a victim of exploitation. Explain.

Answer

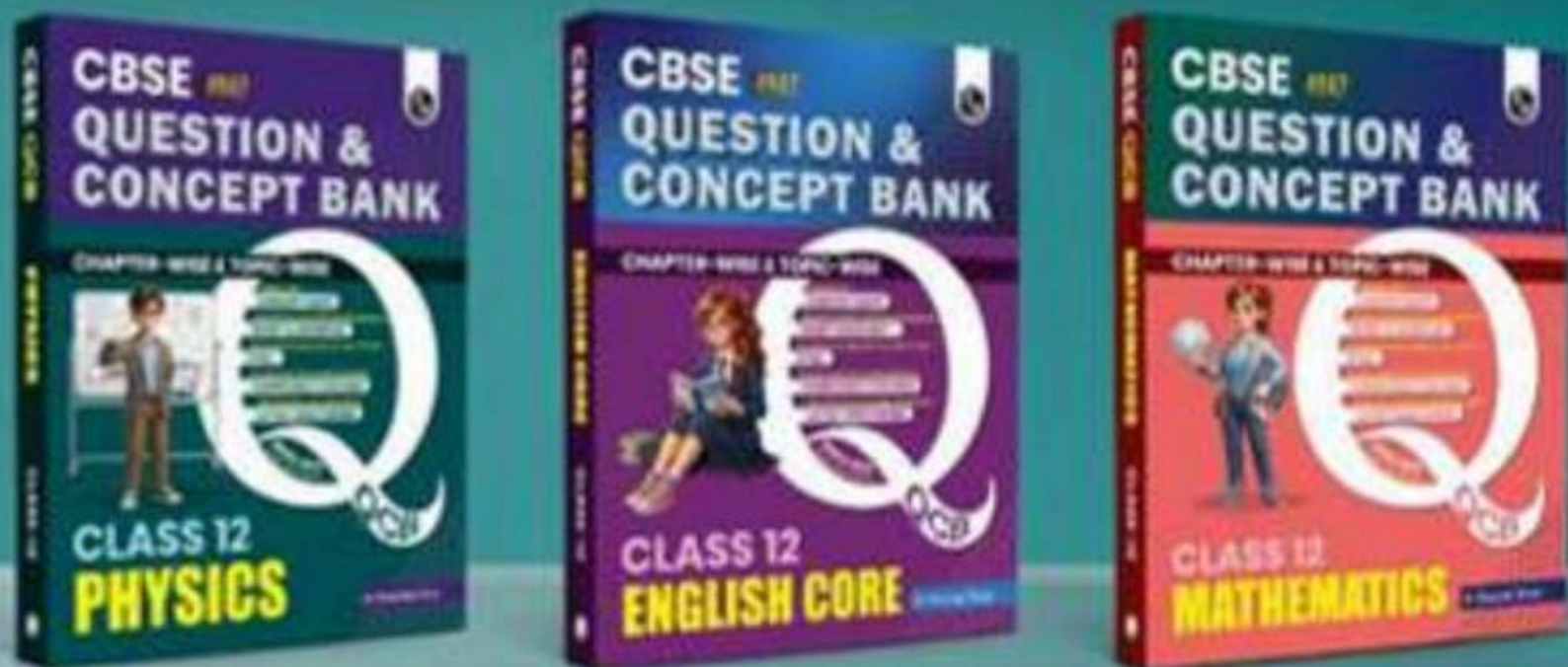
Both Lost Spring and Indigo show the exploitation of poor people. In Lost Spring, children and bangle makers are trapped by poverty, caste and middlemen. In Indigo, Champaran peasants are exploited by British landlords. Both chapters show how the powerless suffer until awareness, courage and leadership bring change.

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- ➡ **Accuracy Metrics:** Learn if your mistakes are conceptual errors or silly calculation slips.
- ➡ **Peer Benchmarking:** See your live rank among classmates to drive healthy competition.

A cinematic scene from a movie. In the foreground, a young boy with curly hair sits on a pile of rubble, looking up with a hopeful expression. To his left, a man sits on the ground, looking down. In the background, a city street is shown with several men standing, including one in a police uniform. Industrial smokestacks are visible in the distance under a hazy, orange-tinted sky.

Thank you!